



Samsung fast(er) charge

"Graphene ball" coating in regular Li-ion cell can push capacity by 45%, and charge 5 times faster.
<http://dgit.in/SamCharge>



Bizzare cambrian worm

Researchers have found 515 mn years old creature with armor and spikes all over its body.
<http://dgit.in/CamWorm>

And it's not confined to one person either. There's multitudes of these speedsters running around, screwing with timelines and what not. And one of the strongest speedsters of them all, Professor Zoom, just died from a bullet? What? We expected more from you DC. Shouldn't people also die if you save them at super speed because moving so fast from inertia will probably shatter all their bones and turn their organs to mush?

This is a very pervasive issue. Even our beloved Harry Potter isn't free from such rule breaking and logical inconsistencies. Apart from the many continuity and timing errors (which were admitted and actually embraced by J.K. Rowling) there are also a lot of "???" moments with rules. Like the Trace. For those of you who aren't as well versed in Potterlore, the Trace is a magical charm put on young wizards when they are babies. It automatically notifies the Ministry of Magic (the agency controlling the wizarding world) when a spell is cast. The location, the exact time and what spells were cast are all relayed there and underage wizards that is, wizards under the age of 17 are then disciplined. An important thing to note is that it just



>Faster than the Flash >is killed with a bullet

detects magic in the presence of the wizard, but not who cast it. So Harry Potter gets in trouble a couple of times, notably once when a house elf casts a spell around him leading to lots of legal trouble. So the rules of the Trace are pretty much straight forward yes? But then there a lot of incidents where it should have activated and it just pretty much didn't. We aren't going

to go into detail here but every single book pretty much has at least one incident where the Trace pretty much was not mentioned at all. There are other moments: like how did the Weasley twins, Fred and George get their hands on the Marauder's map and figure out the password? And in all the time they had it, did they not once notice Peter Pettigrew literally sleeping with Ron all the time? Apparently, rules can be bent to add drama!

Since we're pissing off fans of most fictional universes, we might as well go for broke... What happened to the Rule of the Two of the Sith? In the prequels, Yoda explains that only two Sith may ever exist at a time, but in the original trilogy, Emperor Palpatine and Darth Vader conspire together to recruit Luke which will end up breaking that rule. Or how a foot high yellow electric mouse can't be contained in a 5 inch red and white plastic ball and keeps breaking out, but the literal god of all Pokemon can't? Or how the mother of all Swiss Knives – the Sonic Screwdriver – can pretty much work on anything EXCEPT wood? And why do the machines use humans as batteries in the Matrix? All the energy they spend to keep them alive is probably more than what the collective population can generate, so they would be better off using geothermal or tidal power. If they do require a biological source, cows would have been a better choice as well.

While it might seem like we are nitpicking at minor details here, all this subtracts from immersion. If a fictional universe does make some rules, it needs to stick by them in order to establish cohesion. Just randomly bending or even outright breaking of the rules as and when it suits the story is a bad practice to get into and encourages shoddy writing. If the writers box themselves into a corner, they should be thinking of creative ways to get out of it, instead of sticking a deus ex machina moment there and tweaking the laws to let the main character maintain plot armor. While it is right for the content crea-



We wonder what naughty stuff was revealed through this map

tors to expect us to suspend our disbelief for the sake of entertainment, it's totally unfair of them to expect us to suspend all logic and cohesion. Often, this can lead to plot holes that detract from the experience.

What's even worse, though, is the fact that most people don't even seem to care enough about such glaring errors. They just take for what it is and brush it off as something insignificant which leads to everyone being complacent about such things.

This starts a vicious cycle in which more and more rule-breaking occurs and people ignore it all the time, which leads to even more rule-breaking and eventually just gibberish. People need to demand the enforcement of rules within a fictional universe to encourage the writers to start thinking more outside the box – which isn't unreasonable at all. Set the rules as wacky as you want, but just, for the love of God, stick with them will you?

What do you think? Does the blatant flouting of rules within the Universe irk you? Or do you just prefer to look at the bigger picture and brush it off? Mail us your views at editor@digit.in 